

ing. As far as their privacy is concerned, given that our cricketers have such a hectic playing schedule throughout the year, most of the time we know where they are. And when they are not playing, they are either tied up with sponsorship work or busy using their brand image to further one cause or the other. The bottom line is: if you are an international-level cricketer, it is not very difficult to track you down.

J. AKSHOBHYA, Mysore

Landing a Blow

If Railways Minister and Trinamool Congress leader Mamata Banerjee says no to the Land Acquisition Bill, she has a valid point ("Howrah Express", August 17). Some caution is necessary to make the Government think. We need a humane approach to land acquisition. But the "drama queen" should not turn into a trauma queen for the UPA Government.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, Thiruvananthapuram

Call of Wisdom

Another Nandigram or Singur-like situation may take place unless some sort of wisdom prevails upon the Government of Karnataka while it goes ahead with the proposed airport project at Bellary ("Block and Roll Revolution", August 10). It is surprising that the BJP

that opposed the acquisition of agricultural land at Singur and Nandigram is indulging in something similar at Bellary. These political leaders should understand that infrastructure is definitely required for development but it should not be at the cost of agriculture which is necessary and equally important for development.

LT. COL. RANJIT SINHA (RETD), via www.indiatoday.in



PANKAJ TIWARI

“The Right to Education Bill should have seen the light of day decades ago. Though it looks well-poised now, it remains to be seen how well its contents would be implemented.”

PREM K. MENON, Mumbai

Fading Star

It's high time former railways minister Lalu Prasad Yadav's tall claims were exposed to the public ("Lalu Derailed", August 10). While some credit must be given to Lalu for the so-called turnaround in the Railways, some of the methods used to

achieve this are questionable. If the White Paper on the performance of the Railways proves Mamata Banerjee right, then her predecessor will be called a fake.

ASHOK KUMAR GHOSH, via www.indiatoday.in

A Peace Offering

Unless the US stops giving aid to Pakistan and applies pressure, Pakistan will not dismantle the terror camps operating from its soil

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

OCTOBER 16-31, 1979

A Bitter Battle Ahead

It was, in a sense, the final and supreme irony. As the four top Janata Party leaders began their preliminary election forays around the country last fortnight, they were halted in their tracks. Jayaprakash Narayan, the man who had brought them all together by fostering a new political ideal for them, and who lay crushed by their betrayal, was eventually dead. The timing of JP's death seemed symbolic: he passed away at the precise moment when the political party he had established single-handed was making a desperate bid to revive its fortunes. On the morning of JP's death on October 8, Babu Jagjivan Ram, the Janata's candidate for prime minister-ship, was beginning his tour of Sasaram, the impoverished and drought-stricken region in western Bihar that has been his parliamentary constituency since 1952.

by Sunil Sethi and Arul Louis



JAGJIVAN RAM

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